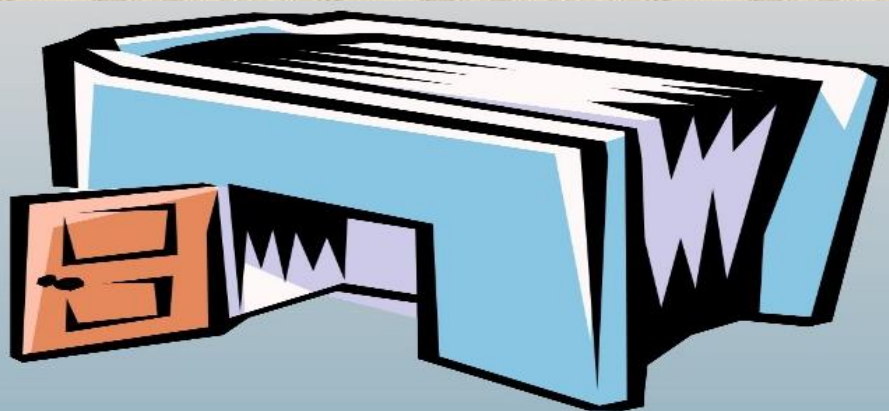




Reading Strategies for Nonfiction Cause and Effect

Created & Developed by Jill M. Leone

Reading Specialist

Copyright © 2007



Today's Objectives

We will discuss -

- difference between causes and effects in nonfiction text.
- strategies to distinguish between causes and effects.

Cause and Effect

- Nothing happens without a reason or without some kind of consequence.
- When you explain **why** things happen and **what** occurs when they do, the technique you use is called **cause and effect**.



Writing About Cause and Effect

- What is a CAUSE?
 - It is what makes something happen
 - (Example: The floor was wet...)
- What is an EFFECT?
 - It is what happens
 - (Example: so, I slipped and fell.)



Writing Tips

- Look for words such as...
 - Since
 - So
 - Because
 - Therefore
 - Due to the fact...to join cause and effect sentences.
 - Use cause and effect in paragraphs to explain how things work
- OR
- how something happens.



Cause and Effect

Cause is **why** something happened.

Effect is the **result** of what happened.

Because effects always have causes and causes always lead to effects, we rarely see one without the other.



Cause and Effect

- The cause is the first thing that happens.
- It makes the second thing (the effect) happen.
- The part of the sentence after the word **because** is the cause.

Example:

I stayed home from school
because I had the flu.



Remember -

The cause
answers
the
question
why?



Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.

Cause and Effect

- The effect is the second thing that happens.
- The effect answers the questions:
What happened?
What was the result?



Example:

Jaime was going too fast and fell off his bicycle.

What happened because Jaime was going too fast?

Activate Windows
Go to Settings to

Understanding Cause and Effect Relationships

- In some paragraphs, the cause-and-effect relationship is not directly stated.
- In these cases, you have to - "read between the lines."
- Use clues from the paragraph to identify cause-and-effect relationships.



Use your prior knowledge.

Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.

Look for effects that are also causes.

Effects can form chains where one effect goes on to cause a second effect, which may then cause a third effect and so on.

Example:

When people pollute rivers, they destroy the habitats of fish. This reduces the number of fish that can reproduce. As a result, fewer fish are born in fresh water, and the fish population declines.

Cause1: People pollute rivers .

Effect 1: The habitats of fish are destroyed.

Effect 2: Fewer fish can reproduce.

Effect 3: Fewer fish are born in fresh water.

Effect 4: The fish population declines.



Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.

Understanding Cause and Effect Relationships

- You use cause and effect every day when you solve problems and make decisions.
- As a result, understanding causes and effects is extremely important in day-to-day living.
- Learning to identify cause and effect relationships helps you understand what is happening in the world around you.



Clue Words for Cause

These expressions indicate cause -

- Because...
- Since...
- Cause..
- Reason..
- So that
- Unless..
- The main reason...



Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.

Let's see how this works –

As a result of his bad fall, Professor Green is wearing bandages and a cast.





Helpful Tip

Try this idea when you are not sure.

When you answer a question that begins with **why**, try putting the word **because** in front of your answer choices. Then read the choices this way to help figure out the correct answer.

Example



The crime rate in Mr. Leon's neighborhood was very high. Many houses had been robbed and cars vandalized. All the neighbors were upset. The mayor ordered the police to patrol the neighborhood. Within two weeks, the neighborhood's crime rate dropped drastically. Finally, everyone felt safe again.



Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.

Why did the crime rate drop?

- A. All the neighbors were upset.
- B. Houses and cars were robbed and vandalized.
- C. The mayor called for added police protection.
- D. Everyone in the neighborhood felt safe again.





Why did the crime rate drop?

- A. **Because** all the neighbors were upset.
- B. **Because** houses and cars were robbed and vandalized.
- C. Because** the mayor called for added police protection.
- D. **Because** everyone in the neighborhood felt safe again.

See how easy this is?



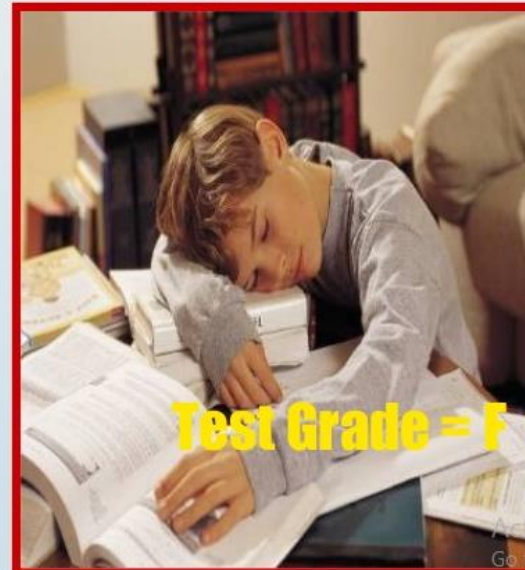
Activate Wind
Go to Settings to a



Clue Words for Effect

These expressions indicate **effect** -

- As a result of
- If
- Consequently
- Effect
- Therefore
- Thus



Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.

Read this Paragraph.



About 75 million people died from the bubonic plague during the 14th century. Half of the population of Italy fell victim to the disease. The plague caused high fever, swollen glands, dark bruises or sores on the face, and spitting of blood. Most people who got the disease died within five days. The disease was spread by fleas from rats. Lack of sanitation and poor medical knowledge account for the continuous plague epidemics throughout the 14th century.

Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.



Practice Question

What caused so many people to die from the bubonic plague?

- Lack of sanitation and poor medical knowledge account for the continuous plague epidemics.
 - The dead were buried without the usual prayers.
 - Italy was constantly at war.
- A. The victims got large bruises or sores on the face.





Practice Question

What caused so many people to die from the bubonic plague?

- Lack of sanitation and poor medical knowledge account for the continuous plague epidemics.
 - The dead were buried without the usual prayers.
 - Italy was constantly at war.
- A. The victims got large bruises or sores on the face.



Practice Question

Marcia was a skilled and capable driver. She had driven all the way from New Mexico in her brand-new car without any problems. Suddenly, because she hit a long patch of frozen ice, she lost control and the car ended up in a ditch. As she climbed out, she realized that the car was demolished.

What was the cause of Marcia's accident?

- A. She was very tired from the long drive.
- B. The road was icy.
- C. The car was new.
- D. She landed in a ditch.



Practice Question

Marcia was a skilled and capable driver. She had driven all the way from New Mexico in her brand-new car without any problems. Suddenly, because she hit a long patch of frozen ice, she lost control and the car ended up in a ditch. As she climbed out, she realized that the car was demolished.

What was the cause of Marcia's accident?

A. She was very tired from the long drive.

B. The road was icy.

C. The car was new.

D. She landed in a ditch.



How did you do?

Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.

Practice Question

The simple sneeze is actually a complex reaction. The impulse to sneeze comes from irritation of a group of nerves in back of the eyes. When the signals reach the brain, the body takes a quick breath, then muscles contract violently. Finally, the sound “kerchoo” comes out.

What is the initial cause of sneeze?

- A. Nerves are irritated.
- B. The brain is signaled.
- C. Eyes are irritated.
- D. Muscles contract violently.



Practice Question

The simple sneeze is actually a complex reaction. The impulse to sneeze comes from irritation of a group of nerves in back of the eyes. When the signals reach the brain, the body takes a quick breath, then muscles contract violently. Finally, the sound “kerchoo” comes out.

What is the initial cause of sneeze?

A. Nerves are irritated. How did you do?

B. The brain is signaled.

C. Eyes are irritated.

D. Muscles contract violently.



Practice Question

Carlos Palomino was a champion boxer. Yet he gave up boxing and earned a degree in recreation. He chose this field because he wanted to work with kids. Not everyone can become a paid athlete, he says. That's why school is so important for all young people. Carlos hopes his example will help others set high goals in education as well in sports.

Why did Carlos get the degree in recreation?

- He had earned many honors.
- He wanted to work with kids.
- Not everyone can become a paid athlete.
- He was an ideal boxer.





Key Strategies and Terms

Today we discussed -

- Causes
- Effects
- Clue Words
- Cause and Effect Relationships



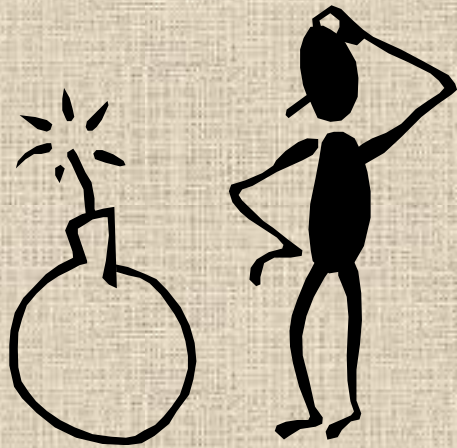
**It doesn't matter whether
you read fiction or
nonfiction -**

Remember!

**As long as
you take
the time to
read!**



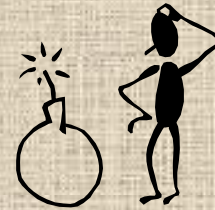
Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows.



Cause and Effect Paragraphs

What is the Purpose?

- To discuss the reasons why something occurs



- To discuss the results of an event, feeling or action



Knowing how to write a good Cause or Effect paragraph is important – most classes, history, biology, journalism, marketing, for example, use this technique to analyze things.

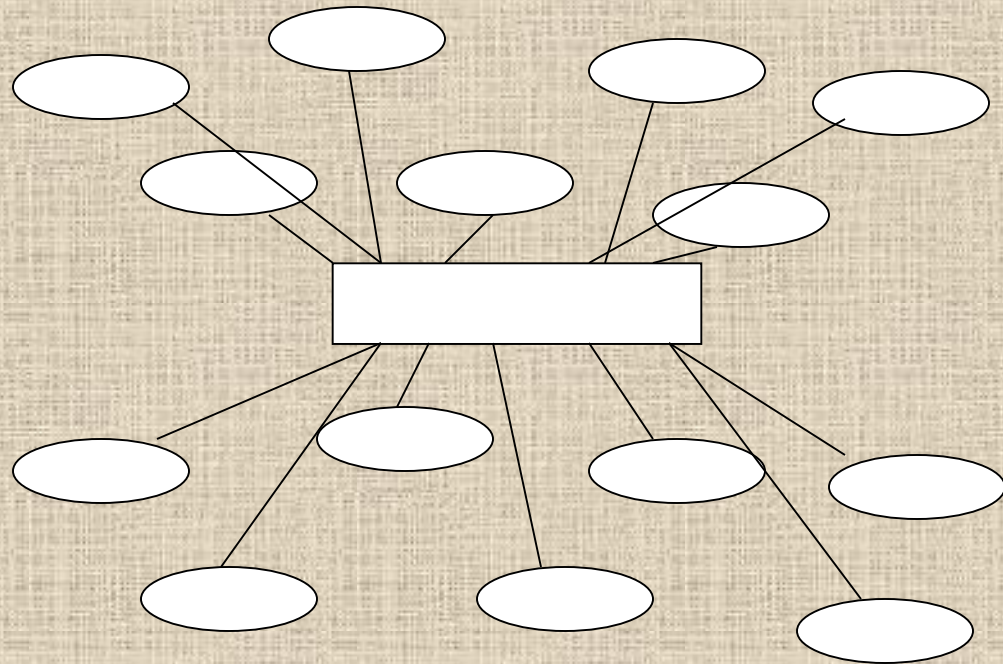
Why do we write these types of paragraphs?

- To understand a situation
- To solve a problem
- To predict an outcome
- To entertain
- To persuade



Brainstorming Techniques

- Listing Causes
- Listing Effects
- Organizer



Achieving Unity

- Unity is achieved in a paragraph by deciding if causes or effects will be the focus.
- Create a topic sentence that focuses on central event, feeling or action.

Achieving Unity

- Is there a link between the causes or effects? Use that link as the controlling idea
 - (e.g.. negative effects, positive outcomes, happy reasons.)

Enhancing Coherence

- To increase coherence, limit the number of causes or effects.
- Decide if there is a chain reaction or individual causes/ effects.

Enhancing Coherence

- Use transitional words that focus the purpose of the paragraph. (in addition to, furthermore, moreover, besides, etc)
- Use support sentences to identify the causes or effects.

Useful Vocabulary

Cause

- **For**
- **Because**
- **Since**
- **Due to**

Effect

- **So**
- **But**
- **For this reason**
- **As a result**
- **Consequently**
- **Otherwise**
- **Therefore**
- **Thus**

Sample Paragraph

Headaches

Headaches can have several causes. Many people think that the major cause of headache is nervous tension, but there is strong evidence that suggests diet and environment as possible factors. Some people get headaches because they are dependent on caffeine. Other people may be allergic to salt, or they may have low blood sugar. Still other people are allergic to household chemicals including polishes, waxes, bug killers, and paint. If they can manage to avoid these substances, their headaches tend to go away. When a person has recurring headaches, it is worthwhile to look for the underlying cause, especially if the result of that search is freedom from pain.

Sample Paragraph with clear support sentences

Headaches

Headaches can have several causes. **One obvious cause is stress.** People have hectic lives and frequently have multiple stressors everyday, like work, family and money. **Another reason for headaches in some people has to do with diet.** Some get headaches because they are dependent on caffeine. Other people may be allergic to salt, or they may have low blood sugar. **The environment can also cause this uncomfortable condition.** Allergens such as household chemicals including polishes, waxes, bug killers, and paint can lead to headaches. Lowering stress, controlling your diet and avoiding allergens can help avoid headaches.

Sample Paragraph

Headaches

Recurring headaches can have several disruptive effects on a person's life. Severe headaches are more than temporary inconveniences. In many cases, these headaches make a person nauseous to the point that he or she must go to bed. Sleep is often interrupted because of the pain. This worsens the physical and emotional state of the sufferer. For those who try to maintain a normal lifestyle, drugs are often relied on to get through the day. Such drugs, of course, can have other negative side effects. Productivity on a job can certainly be reduced, even to the point of regular absences. Finally, perhaps the most distressing aspect of all this is the seemingly unpredictable occurrence of these headaches. The interruption to a person's family life is enormous: cancelling plans in the last minute and straining relationships with friends and family. It is no wonder that many of these people feel discouraged and even depressed.

Sample Paragraph with cause/effect signal words

Headaches

Recurring headaches can have initiate disruptive effects in a person's life. **Initially**, in many cases, these headaches make a person nauseous to the point that he or she must go to bed. **Furthermore**, sleep is often interrupted because of the pain. Disrupted sleep worsens the physical and emotional state of the sufferer. For those who try to maintain a normal lifestyle, drugs are often relied on to get through the day. Such drugs, of course, **can lead to** other negative effects. Drugs can inhibit productivity on a job, perhaps even **causing** regular absences. Not only is work affected, but the seemingly unpredictable occurrence of these headaches **leads to** disruption in family life. The interruption to a person's family life is enormous: cancelling plans in the last minute and straining relationships with friends and family. It is no wonder that many of these people feel discouraged and even depressed due to the cycle of misery reoccurring headaches cause.